

Civic Evidence & Verification

A practical evidence layer for civic information

A working proof of concept that helps people compare what was claimed with what is observed.

TRANSPARENCY & ACCOUNTABILITY · KENYA

1 THE PROBLEM

The Problem

Civic information is fragmented across official announcements, documents, community conversations, and individual reports. A resident may know a project was announced complete, but not whether it is working today. The missing layer is evidence: what was observed, when, by whom, and with what supporting information.

*The problem is not only access to information.
It is the gap between information and evidence.*

2 THE INTENDED USER

The Intended User

A resident checking a promised public project.

For example, a resident can check whether the Kimumu Water Project, announced as completed, is actually providing water. Journalists and watchdog groups can use the same record to compare official claims with recent community reports.

The product is designed around a concrete question: what was promised, what is happening, and what evidence can I inspect?

3 THE SOLUTION

The Solution

Create an evidence layer between institutions and communities.

- **Official record:** status, date, location, organization, and source.
- **Community observations:** dated reports of what people experience on the ground.
- **Supporting evidence:** typed evidence categories and notes.

The platform does not declare who is telling the truth. It keeps the underlying evidence visible so people can make a better-informed assessment.

4 HOW IT WORKS

How It Works

- 1 **Find:** search for a civic project or public service.
- 2 **Understand:** view the official record and its source.
- 3 **Compare:** review recent community observations.
- 4 **Identify:** surface aligned, conflicting, stale, or missing evidence.
- 5 **Contribute:** submit an observation to update the record.

Every verdict includes a clear next step, and shows how many distinct reporters contributed to the recent evidence behind it.

5 EXAMPLE: KIMUMU WATER PROJECT

Example: Kimumu Water Project

OFFICIAL RECORD

Status: Completed | Official status date: July 2026

COMMUNITY OBSERVATIONS

September 10 - **Operational** - Photo evidence

September 13 - **Not operational** - Photo evidence

September 15 - **Operational** - Photo evidence

EVIDENCE STATUS: **CONFLICTING**

Based on reports from 2 independent reporters. The system does not declare which observation is correct; it surfaces the disagreement and invites another observation. All records shown are demonstration data.

6 DESIGNED FOR REAL CONDITIONS

Designed for Real Conditions

- **Multilingual:** working English and Kiswahili interface with a language switcher.
- **Low bandwidth:** server-rendered HTML with no frontend framework, large media, or required JavaScript.
- **Accessible:** semantic headings, labelled controls, keyboard focus, a skip link, text labels alongside color.
- **Private by default:** no account required, anonymous submission available, no device or location data collected.
- **Local:** Kenyan civic projects, locations, and institutions.
- **Scalable:** a generic data model, pluggable languages, and JSON-seeded demo data extend to new regions without code changes.

7 TRUST, ACCURACY, AND WHAT COMES NEXT

Trust, Accuracy, and What Comes Next

TRUST & ACCURACY

- Official records and observations remain separate.
- Dates and evidence notes stay visible.
- Conflicts are shown, never silently resolved.
- The verdict logic is fixed, explicit, and inspectable.

AI TOOLS & ORIGINALITY

The idea, the data model, and the verification logic were specified by the author first. AI tools then built each feature under that direction, with every result reviewed and tested before being accepted. An LLM does not determine the verdict; that logic is explicit and inspectable in the code.

NEXT DEVELOPMENT

Verified public data integrations, trusted-organization signals, geographic analysis, document ingestion, and additional civic services.

Vision: make civic information accessible, traceable, understandable, and easier to scrutinize.